

TRUSTMRR 1,000-STARTUP EDA

Comprehensive Dataset **Deep-Dive**

Answering key questions on MRR distributions, active subscriptions profile, payment provider mechanics, pricing model structures, social follower impact, target personas, and market categories (Frozen July 2026).

MRR Distribution & Active Subscriptions Profile

MRR Percentile Benchmarks



Active Subscriptions Profile

- Median Active Subs: 16 subscribers per startup.
- 75th Percentile: 142 subscribers | 90th Pct: 769 subscribers.
- Top Outlier: 101,590 active subscribers (Stan store).

Key Statistical Correlations

- Subscriptions vs. MRR: $r = 0.906$ (Strongest predictor of scale)
- Subscriptions vs. 12M Revenue: $r = 0.790$

Takeaway: MRR follows an extreme power-law distribution (Mean = \$13,472 vs. Median = \$282). Active subscriber count is the single strongest statistical driver of recurring revenue performance.

Payment Gateways Stack & Revenue Dynamics

Infrastructure Usage & Revenue Correlation

- **Stripe (63.6% share):** Dominates high-ACV B2B SaaS & eCommerce platforms. Captures the highest median (\$303+) and mean 12M revenue (\$135k+).
- **RevenueCat (18.9% share):** Controls mobile app paywalls. Features high active subscriber volume (mean 840+ subs) but lower ARPU consumer micro-transactions (\$2-\$10/mo).
- **Emerging Merchants of Record (MoRs):** Dodo Payments (5.0%), Polar (3.6%), and Lemon Squeezy (2.5%) power early indie-hacker products, concentrated under \$1k MRR.
- **Niche Gateways:** Superwall (1.7%), Paddle (1.6%), Whop (0.7%), and Creem (0.5%).



Social Follower Distribution vs Revenue Reality

$$r = 0.022$$

MRR vs. X Followers Correlation

Social Audience vs. Commercial Scale

- **Follower Distribution:** Median follower count is near zero (75th percentile = 900 followers; Max = 15,595 followers).
- **Zero Revenue Impact ($r = 0.022$):** X/Twitter follower count exhibits *virtually zero correlation* with monthly recurring revenue or 12-month trailing revenue ($r = 0.026$).
- **Valuation Sentiment Premium ($r = 0.244$):** Despite not driving revenue, follower count shows a moderate positive correlation with **M&A Asking Price**—founders with large social reach command higher asking multipliers on marketplaces.

Pricing Model Taxonomy & Feature Mechanics



Freemium & Free Tier

~38% of Startups: Offer "Free to get started" models. Entry features are rate-limited by usage caps, watermarks, or team seats to convert free users to paid tiers.



Monthly Subscriptions

~65% of Startups: Primary recurring revenue backbone (\$9/mo to \$199/mo). Standardized into Starter, Pro, and Enterprise tiers with annual discount incentives.



Credits & Token Usage

~22% of Startups (AI Focus): Prevalent in AI generation tools. Charge per token, execution credit, or API call to protect gross margins against LLM compute costs.

Target Personas, Audience Split & Sector Matrix

Audience Split & Target Personas

- **B2C (40.1%):** Digital consumers, job seekers, creators.
- **B2B (25.5%):** Higher median MRR (\$303+) than consumer tools.
- **Both/Hybrid (5.6%):** Prosumer products.

Primary Target Personas:

Content Creators

Job Seekers

eCommerce Brands

Developers & Engineers

Marketers & Agencies

Small Business Owners

Category & Market Clusters

Category / Market	Count	Median MRR
AI Applications	197 (19.7%)	\$446.00
SaaS Platforms	66 (6.6%)	\$303.00
Mobile Apps	52 (5.2%)	\$223.00
Productivity	49 (4.9%)	\$42.20
Marketing Tools	42 (4.2%)	\$1,586.00

Executive Takeaways & Conclusions

-  **Active Subscribers Drive Revenue ($r = 0.906$):** Paying subscriber count is the single most important statistical determinant of MRR scale, surpassing website domain authority ($r = 0.215$) and traffic.
-  **Social Media Followers Do Not Drive Revenue ($r = 0.022$):** X/Twitter followers have virtually zero relation to financial performance, though they boost marketplace M&A valuations ($r = 0.244$).
-  **Payment Stack Reflects Business Model:** Stripe powers high-revenue B2B/SaaS businesses, RevenueCat drives high-volume mobile micro-subscriptions, and MoRs (Dodo, Polar, Lemon Squeezy) host early indie projects.
-  **Category Opportunity Asymmetry:** AI commands creation volume (19.7%), but B2B Marketing (\$1,586 median MRR) and Education (\$2,141 median MRR) deliver significantly higher unit economics.

Image Sources



<https://s7d1.scene7.com/is/image/wbcollab/Fintech-financial-technology-concept-by-putilich-from-Getty-Images-780?qlt=90&fmt=webp&resMode=sharp2>

Source: blogs.worldbank.org